

Teacher Manual — MJ U.S. History 1492–Reconstruction

Facilitator copy. Contains answer guides, rubrics, grading thresholds, and sensitive-content scripts.

Do not publish this document to students. It documents the course as built: eighteen weekly modules (Weeks 1–18, Quarters 1–2 of a full-year, four-quarter design), two Quarter Capstones, two Quarterly MC Exams, and the recurring weekly assessment set — Reading Quiz, Critical Questions, Primary Source Exercise/Report, Discussion, two VR Activities, and (on nine weeks) an interactive widget. Keep it in your teacher files and re-render it if the course is revised.

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SECTION

0 How to use this manual

This is the facilitator guide for MJ U.S. History 1492–Reconstruction. It assumes you already have access to the built Canvas course (course 79) and its linked lesson pages. Read Sections 1, 2, and 4 before your first week; keep Sections 5, 6, and 7 open while you grade; use Section 10 to plan your pacing calendar and Section 15 if you run a Live section. Everything here is drawn from the course as it actually exists and was verified directly against the live Canvas course, not assumed from build notes. Anything that depends on your school's current Canvas configuration is marked **[VERIFY]**.

SECTION

1 How this course works — typical lesson, typical module, major assessments

A typical lesson page. Every lesson follows the same shape: a header and metadata strip; three or four “I will be able to...” objectives; a Glossary of Subject Vocabulary box at the top (only on the lesson where a term first appears, and again on the immediately following lesson — never longer than that window); content blocks, with a Foreign Language Vocabulary box placed inline near the first use of any non-English term; and a closing “What You’ll Do Next” section linking the graded items that follow. On nine of the thirty-six lessons (Weeks 1, 3, 6, 7, 9, 12, 14, 17, 18) the lesson is a GitHub-hosted interactive document carrying one embedded widget — a map,

sorter, sequencer, or matcher tied to that week's specific content — ungraded and self-checking. The other twenty-seven lessons are plain Canvas pages.

The graded touchpoints are never on the lesson page itself. They are the separate Canvas items that follow it in the module: the Reading Quiz, the linked Primary Sources, Critical Questions, the Primary Source Exercise or Report, and the Discussion.

A typical module. One numbered module fills one week, exactly — there is no multi-week module in this course. Every module follows the identical internal shape:

Segment	What the student does	Graded?	Tier
Module Intro Wrapper (every module)	Answers the module's essential question cold; acknowledges the objectives; opts in/out of the quarter's optional capstone group work	Completion (survey)	4
Lesson 1	Reads the lesson page (Reading Topic, first half)	No	1
Reading Quiz	5–8 auto-graded multiple-choice inference questions on Lesson 1	Auto	1
Primary Source 1	Reads the week's first assigned primary source	No	1
Critical Questions	Two open-ended reasoned answers on Primary Source 1	Teacher-graded	2
Lesson 2 + Primary Source 2	Second half of the week's topic and its source	No	1
Primary Source Exercise (11 weeks) or Primary Source Report (7 featured weeks)	Two open-ended reasoned answers on Primary Source 2; Reports add a 250–400 word M365 Word-document response and the Section 5 rubric	Teacher-graded	2 (Exercise) or 3 (Report)
Discussion	Defends a specific claim from the week's Discussion Topic, then responds to a classmate	Teacher-graded (light)	2
Two VR Activities	One in-headset session tied to the week's content, feeding the quarter's Primary Source Portfolio Wall	Completion	1
Interactive widget (9 of 18 weeks)	Ungraded self-check embedded in the lesson	No	4
Module Outro Wrapper (every module)	Revisits the essential question; rates confidence; names what's still unclear; reflects on the module's virtue	Completion (survey)	4

Major assessments. Beyond the recurring weekly set, the course carries four milestones: the Quarter 1 Exam (27 multiple-choice questions, end of Module 9), the Quarter 1 Capstone *The Contingent Colonies*, the Quarter 2 Exam (27 questions, end of Module 18), and the Quarter 2 Capstone *The Contingent Republic* (the Fall Semester Final Project). All four sit in Tier 3 alongside the seven Primary Source Reports — see Sections 5 and 7 for how they're weighted and graded.

Module map.

Module	Topic	Featured assignment
1	European Exploration and the Discovery of America	Reading Quiz

2	Spanish Conquistadors Make Latin America	Primary Source Report
3	Great Powers Competition in the New World	VR Activity
4	The First English Settlements: Jamestown and the Chesapeake	VR Activity
5	Religious Reformers in New England	Primary Source Report
6	Mid-Atlantic and Southern Colonies	Reading Quiz
7	Atlantic Trade Routes and the Slave Trade	Reading Quiz
8	Massachusetts Bay Colony and Puritanism	Reading Quiz
9	The French and Indian War	VR Activity — <i>Quarter 1 Exam and Capstone follow</i>
10	Colonial Self-Government: Assemblies, Charters, Representative Government	Primary Source Report
11	British Policy and Colonial Grievances, Part I (1763–1770)	Primary Source Report
12	British Policy and Colonial Grievances, Part II (1770–1776)	Primary Source Report
13	The Road to Revolution: The Patriots	Reading Quiz
14	The Declaration of Independence	Primary Source Report
15	The American Revolution, Part I: Early Campaigns	VR Activity
16	The American Revolution, Part II: Turning Points, Alliances, and Victory	Reading Quiz
17	The Articles of Confederation and the Constitutional Convention	Primary Source Report
18	Ratification, the Bill of Rights, and Washington's Presidency	Reading Quiz — <i>Quarter 2 Exam and Capstone follow</i>

SECTION

2 Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers

Two things new facilitators most often misread:

- **The ungraded interactives cost you nothing.** The vocabulary glossary boxes, the nine embedded widgets, and the speaker-icon pronunciation buttons on the GitHub-hosted lessons give students immediate feedback and never produce a submission. A student who skips them will show it indirectly — a weaker Reading Quiz score, a thinner Critical Questions answer — not as a missing grade. Do not build a gradebook column for them.
- **The wrappers are Canvas Quizzes in survey mode, not pages.** That data is the whole point of making them quizzes rather than pages — it is sortable across your roster.

Wrapper	Q#	Type	What it captures
Intro (every module)	1	Essay	The module's essential question, answered cold

	2	Multiple choice	Objectives acknowledgment (Yes / Not yet)
	3	Multiple choice	Group-work opt-in for the quarter's optional capstone (Yes / No / Undecided)
Outro (every module)	1	Essay	The same essential question, revisited — “say what changed it”
	2	Multiple choice	Five-point confidence rating
	3	Essay	Free response: what's still unclear
	4	Essay	Reflection naming the module's virtue

The single highest-leverage move in the course. Spend 15–20 minutes reading each module's Outro Wrapper responses as a set. Sort for low-confidence clusters and repeated “still unclear” concepts. Then act: post one targeted announcement addressing the top confusion, and message the two or three students whose confidence dropped. This finds struggling students before a grade would.

SECTION

3 VR in this course

Every module carries two solo VR activities — thirty-six across the semester, no exceptions — each a single in-headset session bundling two or three connected tasks (observe, arrange or annotate, record). Both feed a running Primary Source Portfolio Wall, a persistent gallery environment that becomes the evidentiary base for that quarter's capstone. On the four weeks the module map flags “VR Activity” as the featured assignment (Modules 3, 4, 9, 15), one of the two sessions is the richer, headline activity tied directly to that week's central event; the paired session that week, and both sessions on every other week, are lighter skill-building or portfolio sessions.

Always describe VR in platform-neutral terms: VR session ID, Environment, spawn point, sticky notes, spatial recording. Never “room” or “world” as a substitute for Environment — the platform this course runs on is not named in student- or teacher-facing text, so the course is not tied to one vendor. Every VR assignment states a title, what the student is doing, what they'll need, how to join, numbered steps, what to submit, an honest time estimate, and a completion-based rubric.

SECTION

4 Grading categories & Canvas gradebook setup

The course exports with four weighted assignment groups — the Tier system from optima-canvas-assignments, not a bespoke split. Weights are percentage-based; confirm they imported intact.

Group id	Group	Weight	What's in it
205	Tier 1: Student & Material	55%	Reading Quizzes (18) and completion-graded VR Activities (36)
227	Tier 2: Student & Community	30%	Discussions (18), Critical Questions (18), Primary Source Exercises on non-featured weeks (11)

228	Tier 3: Student & Teacher	15%	Primary Source Reports on featured weeks (7), both Quarter Capstones, both Quarterly MC Exams
229	Tier 4: Ungraded scaffolding	0%	Module Intro/Outro wrapper surveys, the M365 Setup & File Organization Guide, widget-carrying lesson pages

Common mix-up worth flagging: both Quarterly MC Exams are auto-graded multiple choice, which reads like Tier 1 at a glance — but they are deliberately placed in **Tier 3** (group 228), the same group as the Primary Source Reports and Capstones, per `optima-mj-social-studies`' instruction to join quarter-culminating milestone work to whichever existing group already holds it. Check the group column, not the scoring method, before assuming an item's tier.

1. Gradebook > Settings > Weight final grade based on assignment groups. Confirm the four groups above and their weights (55 / 30 / 15 / 0).
2. Confirm each item sits in the right group: Reading Quizzes and VR → Tier 1. Discussions, Critical Questions, and non-featured-week Primary Source Exercises → Tier 2. Featured-week Primary Source Reports, both Capstones, and both Quarterly Exams → Tier 3.
3. Confirm both wrappers on every module are survey/completion (zero points, no assignment-group), so they gather data without distorting grades.

SECTION

5 Rubrics & answer guides for teacher-graded items

One base rubric (Canvas rubric id 393, "Primary Source Report," 16 points) covers all seven Primary Source Reports. Each Quarter Capstone adds one criterion on top of the same base, worth more points for the fuller, longer-form work.

Criterion	Report (393)	Q1 Capstone (394)	Q2 Capstone (395)
Understanding of the material	4 pts	4 pts	4 pts
Quality of reasoning	4 pts	4 pts	4 pts
Clarity and precision of expression	4 pts	4 pts	4 pts
Intellectual honesty	4 pts	4 pts	4 pts
Coherence across the quarter	—	4 pts	—
Depth across both quarters	—	—	8 pts
Total	16	20	24

Each criterion scores Excellent (100%) / Proficient (75%) / Developing (50%) / Beginning (25%). The Q2 Capstone weights "Depth across both quarters" at double the other criteria, since it is the semester's one item that legitimately asks a student to synthesize Quarter 1 and Quarter 2 together.

Answer guides — teacher only, never shown to students. Every Critical Questions and Primary Source item carries exactly two open-ended questions, drawn from a four-category reasoning menu (counterfactual, causation, concept-identification, significance) and rotated week to week so the same pair never repeats — the category itself is never labeled in student-facing text. Full credit on a *conceptual* question means the student names the underlying idea the source itself never states outright. The course's own worked example is Week 14: given the Declaration of Independence's preamble, a full-credit answer identifies Locke's natural law and social-contract theory as the framework Jefferson is applying, and states what it is being used to justify — separation

from Britain on the grounds that government exists by the consent of the governed. A partial-credit answer names “freedom” or “rights” without the Lockean framework; a no-credit answer restates the preamble’s language without identifying any theory behind it. Full credit on a *counterfactual* question requires an argument, not just a guess — a student who argues that the other colonies would have supported Massachusetts alone under a narrower Quartering Act, citing the actual historical pattern of intercolonial solidarity, demonstrates more knowledge than one who simply asserts they would not have bothered, regardless of which conclusion is “more right.”

SECTION

6 Assessment & activity catalog — how to run and grade each type

Type	Scoring	Recommended move
Reading Quiz (Tier 1)	Auto-graded MC, 5–8 items	Leave to auto-grade. Scan item analysis for a question the whole cohort missed — that’s your next announcement, not a regrade.
Critical Questions (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded, two open-ended questions	Grade in a batch per module. Lead feedback with what the student did well before naming the next step.
Primary Source Exercise (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded, two open-ended questions, lighter than a Report	Same batch pass as Critical Questions; no rubric required beyond a completion/quality check.
Primary Source Report (Tier 3)	Teacher-graded, two questions plus a 250–400 word M365 Word document, Section 5 rubric	Attach the rubric 393 as a native Canvas Rubric so it scores in SpeedGrader; budget more time per student than a plain Exercise.
Discussion (Tier 2)	Teacher-graded, light	Score on a simple substantive/thin/missing scale; drop 2–3 public comments per cycle modeling good thinking.
Quarterly MC Exam (Tier 3)	Auto-graded MC, 27 items, non-cumulative	Leave to auto-grade. Review the item analysis to spot a systemic gap before you move into the next quarter.
Quarter Capstone (Tier 3)	Teacher-graded, rubric 394 or 395	The one deep-feedback item per quarter — budget real per-student time here.
Module Intro / Outro Wrapper (Tier 4)	Survey / completion	Do not score for correctness. Read the outro as a set (Section 2).
VR Activity (Tier 1)	Completion	Check the capture happened; assemble an occasional gallery walk from the Portfolio Wall.
Interactive widget (Tier 4)	Ungraded	Nothing to do; formative only, embedded in the lesson.

SECTION

7 Quarterly exams

Two Quarterly MC Exams — Canvas Quizzes 2503 (Quarter 1, Modules 1–9) and 2504 (Quarter 2, Modules 10–18) — each carry 27 multiple-choice questions worth 27 points, are non-cumulative (each covers only its own quarter), and sit as a module item immediately before that module’s Outro Wrapper (end of Module 9 for Q1, end of Module 18 for Q2).

The grading-weight recommendation, corrected. optima-mj-social-studies Section II asks the manual to recommend the two exams together land around 30% of the semester grade. That figure is **not achievable here**: both exams sit in Tier 3, and Tier 3's contribution to the semester grade is capped at 15% by group weighting, regardless of how points are distributed among the items inside it — no combination of point values can push it to 30% without also changing the group weight itself, which would affect every other Tier 3 item too.

The workable recommendation is different: set each exam's point value so the two exams together make up a **meaningful minority share of Tier 3's own internal point total**, alongside the seven Primary Source Reports and two Capstones. As built, Tier 3 totals 210 points ($7 \times 16 + 20 + 24 + 27 + 27$), and the two exams' 54 points are about 26% of that total — a meaningful minority share without dominating the group. If you adjust an exam's point value, re-check this ratio rather than reaching for the retired 30%-of-semester figure; that number cannot be satisfied under this course's group weighting and should not be reintroduced.

SECTION

8 Teacher workflow & workload map

A normal week, in order: triage outro-wrapper analytics (module boundaries) → batch-grade the week's Critical Questions and Primary Source item → skim VR captures → score the Discussion and drop 2–3 public comments → post the weekly announcement → answer messages. Tier 1 auto-grades at near zero teacher hours; the Quarterly Exams also auto-grade at near zero hours, twice a semester.

The real Tier 2 load is above the skill's generic default, and it is structural, not a build error. optima-canvas-assignments budgets 2–3 hours per week for Tier 2 across a course generally. This course's real Tier 2 load is **47 teacher-read items per full cycle** — 18 Discussions, 18 Critical Questions sets, and 11 Primary Source Exercises, every one an online_text_entry submission a human has to read. That is because optima-mj-social-studies Section IV.2 requires exactly two open-response questions on every primary source, every week, on top of the weekly Discussion — three separate written-response touchpoints per module rather than one. Tier 1 totals 54 auto-graded items (36 VR Activities, 18 Reading Quizzes) at near-zero teacher time; Tier 3 totals 11 items (7 Primary Source Reports, 2 Capstones, 2 Quarterly Exams), the smallest count but the deepest per-item feedback. Use these three counts — 54 / 47 / 11 — to calibrate your own pacing, not the skill's generic weekly-hours estimate, which assumes a lighter Tier 2 load than this course actually carries.

Tier	Item count	What it is	Teacher time
1	54	36 VR Activities + 18 Reading Quizzes	Near zero — auto/completion
2	47	18 Discussions + 18 Critical Questions + 11 Primary Source Exercises	The real weekly load — three written touchpoints per module
3	11	7 Primary Source Reports + 2 Capstones + 2 Quarterly Exams	Fewest items, deepest per-item feedback

Where the load concentrates. Every module carries an identical shape (one Discussion, one Critical Questions set, and one Primary Source Exercise or Report), so the per-week grading load is flat across all eighteen modules rather than peaking in any one of them — the seven featured Primary Source Report weeks (2, 5, 10, 11, 12, 14, 17) are where an individual item takes longer, since a Report adds the 250–400 word M365 response and the Section 5 rubric on top of the same two questions an Exercise week carries.

SECTION

9 Standards coverage

This course is aligned to Florida's SS.8.A (U.S. History), SS.68.AA (African American History), SS.8.CG (Civics and Government), and SS.8.HC (Historical Contingency) benchmarks for the Fall-semester content (Weeks 1–18, European exploration through Washington's presidency). The full crosswalk lives in [03_Build/weeks/99-standards-appendix.html](#). Every benchmark that belongs to this semester's content is satisfied by at least one lesson and at least one assessment students submit. Benchmarks belonging to the Spring-semester content (Jefferson and Adams's presidencies through westward expansion, the Civil War, and Reconstruction) are out of scope for this build and are listed separately at the end of the appendix as a reference for that future build phase.

Category	Code range	Benchmarks	Coverage
Historical Thinking Skills	SS.8.A.1.x	7	Addressed every week
Colonial Era Content	SS.8.A.2.x	7	Weeks 1–9
Revolutionary Era Content	SS.8.A.3.x	14	Weeks 9–18
African American History	SS.68.AA.x	7	Concentrated Week 7, recurring through 17
Civics/Government & Historical Contingency	SS.8.CG.x / SS.8.HC.1.1	9	Spread across Weeks 4–18
Total tabulated by week		44 , plus MTR and ELA Expectations standards addressed throughout	

There is no EOC index in this manual, and that is deliberate, not an oversight. Florida's U.S. History End-of-Course Assessment tests 91 benchmarks, all coded SS.912.A, and its earliest assessed content is the causes and consequences of the Civil War — this course's benchmarks are all SS.8.A/SS.68.AA/SS.8.CG/SS.8.HC, and this Fall build ends at Washington's presidency. There is no benchmark-code overlap and no content overlap between what this course teaches and what that exam tests. optima-mj-social-studies exempts Grade 7 U.S. History from building an EOC-standard index or gap-fill exercises for exactly this reason — the actual EOC for this subject is a high-school course years away. Do not build one here on the strength of the Civics course's EOC section; this course genuinely has no honest EOC alignment to index yet.

SECTION

10 Module-vs-week mapping and suggested pacing

Module N = Week N, one to one, for all eighteen modules — there is no compression or multi-week module anywhere in this course. “Module N” is the only label students see; “Week N” survives only in this manual and the syllabi, which are a separate administrative document family (see Section 12). The table below is the sample full-year pacing calendar from the official syllabi — a suggested reference for you, never shown to students as a schedule.

Modules	Milestone	Target date
1–4	European Exploration and Colonial America	By Sep 12, 2026
5–9	Quarter 1 Complete	By Oct 9, 2026
10–14	Revolution and Founding Era	By Nov 7, 2026
15–18	Quarter 2 Complete · Fall Semester End	By Dec 18, 2026

Quarters 3 and 4 (Modules 19–36, Jacksonian Democracy through Reconstruction) are future build phases and carry no built content yet; the syllabi's own pacing rows for them are placeholders, not this manual's concern.

SECTION

11 Vocabulary and reading-level conventions

Every lesson targets 800–1,200 words (1,000 the sweet spot) and a glossary window of exactly two lessons: the lesson where a term first appears, and the immediately following lesson only, even if the word recurs later in the course. Subject-vocabulary terms get a boxed definition with phonetic spelling at the top of the lesson; foreign-language terms get a separate box placed inline near their first use, with the English gloss bolded and the foreign term italicized in parentheses. The nine GitHub-hosted widget lessons additionally wire a speaker-icon button to the browser's built-in text-to-speech for each glossed term; the other twenty-seven plain Canvas lesson pages cannot run this, since Canvas strips embedded scripts, and carry the phonetic spelling only — a documented, accepted limitation, not a silent gap (see Section 12).

Reading level, stated honestly. All thirty-six lessons were rewritten in 2026 to land in the 800–1,200 word band, and reading level improved substantially, but it does not uniformly hit the school's 6th-grade target: Quarter 1 lessons settled mostly in the 6–11 range (two lessons at 11–13), and Quarter 2 lessons settled mostly in the 8–10 range (two lessons at 10.5 and 11.0). This gap is a documented, accepted limitation driven by the density of required historical vocabulary at this content level, not an oversight — do not represent this course's lessons as uniformly 6th-grade reading level to a family or administrator who asks.

SECTION

12 Documented, accepted exceptions

These are deliberate decisions, made and recorded, not oversights — do not "fix" them without revisiting the underlying decision first.

- **Fall/Spring language.** Both syllabi and the lesson/capstone pages keep "Fall Semester" and "Quarter 2 Complete · Fall Semester End" language, against the general house style rule against "Fall"/"Spring" labels, because it communicates a real, board-approved academic-calendar milestone families need.
- **The conditional-publish limitation.** House style asks that a lesson's in-lesson assessment link render only once the teacher has published that assessment, showing a "not yet assigned" message otherwise. Canvas has no primitive for conditionally rendering page-body HTML on another item's publish state; the actual behavior is that a link to an unpublished item is simply inaccessible to students, not conditionally hidden. Accepted as a Canvas platform limitation.
- **The Module Map is a teacher/print artifact only.** The page-break section at the top of each week file (This Week's Objectives, the Week-at-a-Glance weekday table, and the Intro Wrapper acknowledgment card) is deliberately never deployed to Canvas — Canvas modules open straight into the Intro Wrapper quiz instead, and the per-lesson objectives it duplicates already appear on the lesson pages. Do not push it as a student-facing Canvas page.
- **The TTS speaker-icon split.** The nine GitHub-hosted widget lessons get a working pronunciation button; the other twenty-seven plain Canvas lessons get the phonetic spelling only, because Canvas strips embedded scripts from page bodies. See Section 11.

SECTION

13 What makes this course classical

- **Contingency first.** Every week surfaces at least one moment where history could plausibly have gone otherwise — the counterfactual slot in the rotating two-question format exists specifically for this. The

whole semester itself is a contingency argument: the American Revolution's success, and therefore the existence of a U.S. History to teach at all, was not guaranteed.

- **Great Men and Great Events as the narrative spine.** The semester climaxes with the Revolution and the Founding (Modules 14–18); every earlier module is written to feed that arc — colonial self-government habits, accumulating grievances, and the ideas of natural rights that the Declaration ultimately states outright.
- **Classical Republican evaluation.** Character traits are named only where they carry real explanatory weight — Cortés's boldness, Bacon's recklessness, Samuel Adams's organizing shrewdness, Washington's steadiness — not as a moral tally. Washington's slaveholding, for instance, is a moral failure worth naming when it is relevant to the point a lesson is making, not catalogued apart from that context.
- **Primary sources, every week.** Students meet Columbus, Díaz, Winthrop, Paine, Jefferson, and the Constitution itself directly, not a textbook's summary of them.

SECTION

14 Sensitive-content flags & family/student scripts

Flag these in advance. Give a neutral setup; save any debate for the lesson.

Where	What
Module 2	The Spanish conquest of Mexico and the epidemic collapse of Native populations following contact. Per this course's historiographical stance, this must be taught as an unintended consequence of Old World disease, not a deliberate campaign — teach it accurately and without minimizing the scale of the loss, but do not import intent that was not there.
Module 4	The Anglo-Powhatan Wars: sustained violent conflict between the Jamestown colony and the Powhatan Confederacy.
Module 7	The Atlantic slave trade, including the Middle Passage and colonial slave codes, drawn directly from Clarkson's primary-source argument against the trade's legality.

"Dear families, in the coming weeks our class reads primary sources dealing with [the epidemic collapse of Native populations after European contact / sustained conflict between Jamestown and the Powhatan Confederacy / the Atlantic slave trade]. We approach this material soberly and historically, using the actual sources rather than a summary, because understanding how this era actually unfolded is central to U.S. History. If you'd like to talk through the material or have questions, please reach out — [name], [email], office hours [day/time]."

SECTION

15 Running this course live

The course is written once and runs in two sections from the same content: Live (synchronous) and On-Demand (asynchronous). The syllabi differ only in section logistics, not academic content.

Live (synchronous)		On-Demand (asynchronous)
You're called	Teacher	Facilitator
Contact	Scheduled office hours	Weekly study hall and VR workshops

Pacing	Scheduled class meetings on Optima's VR campus and Microsoft Teams	Self-paced within each quarter, guided by due dates
Attendance measured by	Presence and participation; notify in advance of an absence	Assignment completion; flagged after 10 consecutive school days with no submission

Turning the weekly segment list into a live rhythm. Nothing in the built course prescribes a fixed number of live meetings per week, so use the module's own segment order (Section 1) as your seminar plan: open with the Intro Wrapper's essential question as a live warm-up; teach Lesson 1 and hold the Primary Source 1 reading as a group seminar, using the Critical Questions prompts as your discussion spine before students write; teach Lesson 2 and run that week's VR activities as a shared session with everyone in the same Environment, followed by a short gallery walk of captures; and close by having students draft the Primary Source Exercise or Report in class, where you can coach in real time, before the Outro Wrapper on a module's last week. The Reading Quiz works well as a live warm-up or exit ticket either way — same auto-grading, but it now also tells you what to reteach before the next seminar. The Section 5 rubric and Section 7 exam placement apply identically to both sections; if you want your Live section's exams weighted differently within Tier 3 than the course default, that is a per-section gradebook adjustment, not a change to the shared course setup.

MJ U.S. History 1492–Reconstruction · Florida 2100010 · Facilitator Manual, Optima Academy Online, 2026–2027. Synthesized from the built Canvas course (18 modules, Weeks 1–18; Reading Quizzes, Critical Questions, Primary Source Exercises/Reports, Discussions, VR Activities, two Quarterly MC Exams, two Quarter Capstones, and Module Intro/Outro wrappers) and its SS.8.A / SS.68.AA / SS.8.CG / SS.8.HC standards alignment. Facilitator copy — not for student distribution.